

RUI XIAO

Ph.D. Candidate in Multimodal Learning • Technical University of Munich • Munich, Germany

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EDUCATION

Technical University of Munich

Ph.D. Candidate, Multimodal Learning • Advisor: Prof. Dr. Zeynep Akata

Mar. 2025 – present

Munich, Germany

Technical University of Munich

M.Sc. Robotics, Cognition, Intelligence • GPA: 1.4 / 1.0

Oct. 2021 – Oct. 2024

Munich, Germany

Jilin University

B.Eng. Automotive Engineering • GPA: 90.28 / 100 • Rank: 1 / 31

Sep. 2017 – Jul. 2021

Changchun, China

ON-GOING PROJECTS

VERVE: Verified Visual Search

Rui Xiao*, Yiran Huang*, Zeynep Akata†, Stephan Alaniz†

Preprint, 2026

[Paper](#) [Project](#) [Models](#)

- New benchmark: state-of-the-art visual search methods hallucinate more than their base models.
- GRPO training with on-policy self-verification; our 9B model beats Gemini-3.7-Flash by 13.8% on VERVE-MCQ.

PUBLICATIONS

FINER: MLLMs Hallucinate under Fine-grained Negative Queries

Rui Xiao, Sanghwan Kim, Yongqin Xian, Zeynep Akata, Stephan Alaniz

CVPR 2026 • **Oral (award candidate)**

[Paper](#) [Code](#) [Project](#)

Training-free Uncertainty Guidance for Complex Visual Tasks with MLLMs

Sanghwan Kim, Rui Xiao, Stephan Alaniz, Yongqin Xian, Zeynep Akata

ECCV 2026 • Poster

[Paper](#) [Code](#) [Project](#)

FLAIR: VLM with Fine-grained Language-informed Image Representations

Rui Xiao, Sanghwan Kim, Iuliana Georgescu, Zeynep Akata, Stephan Alaniz

CVPR 2025 • Poster

[Paper](#) [Code](#) [Project](#)

COSMOS: Cross-Modality Self-Distillation for Vision Language Pre-training

Sanghwan Kim, Rui Xiao, Iuliana Georgescu, Stephan Alaniz, Zeynep Akata

CVPR 2025 • Poster

[Paper](#) [Code](#) [Project](#)

SCOPE: Structural Continuity Preservation for Retinal Vessel Segmentation

Yousef Yeganeh*, Göktuğ Güvercin*, Rui Xiao*, Amr Abuzer, Ehsan Adeli, Azade Farshad, Nassir Navab

MICCAI 2023 GRAIL Workshop • **Oral**

[Paper](#)

* equal contribution † equal advising

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Self-supervised Tumor Inpainting and Segmentation in CT-PET Data

[Code](#)

Research Assistant (HiWi), TUM CAMP & ABX • Supervisor: Prof. Thomas Wendler

Jul. 2023 – Mar. 2024

Munich, Germany

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer: IJCV, CVPR 2026, ECCV 2026

2025 – present

Student Organizer, Workshop on Knowledge-intensive Multimodal Reasoning

2025 – 2026

CVPR 2026 • ICCV 2025

HONORS AND AWARDS

Oral, Award Candidate, CVPR 2026 (FINER)

2026

National Scholarship (top 1%), Jilin University

During B.Eng.

SKILLS

Programming: Python, PyTorch, Git • Languages: Chinese & Cantonese (native), English (C1), German (C1)